

Kanban Process Improvement Hub (slightly informal but collaborative tone)



Purpose:

This page serves as the **parent hub** for documenting and refining our **Kanban-style Agile process improvements**.

The goal is to streamline how we manage, visualize, and measure ongoing work across QA and Automation teams—ensuring **clarity, accountability, and continuous improvement**.

Background

The automation regression team has evolved without a formal Scrum Master or Business Systems Analyst. Given this, the **Admin Workstream** will establish a clear, repeatable Kanban-based process to ensure:

- Streamlined coordination between **onshore and offshore** resources.
- Continuous delivery visibility for leadership.
- Defined ownership and accountability for all QA activities.

Scope

The focus of this initiative is to:

- Implement **standardized Kanban practices** across all QA and Automation boards/team.
- Establish clear **visibility into work progress, throughput, and delivery timelines**.
- Define a **consistent process** for backlog management, prioritization, and refinement.
- Create **measurable reporting and dashboards** to track performance and improvement.
- Build an **administrative structure** that supports leadership visibility and team autonomy.
- Document and maintain **best practices, templates, and team agreements**.

Responsibilities

- **Brenda** – Lead efforts to formalize Kanban best practices, guide refinement sessions, and help drive offshore accountability.
- **Swapnil** – Oversee process implementation, ensure alignment with leadership expectations, and maintain visibility through dashboards and reports.
- **Team Leads / Offshore Members** – Update JIRA boards regularly, participate in refinement sessions, and adhere to Kanban discipline.
- **All Team Members** – Follow workflow guidelines, provide timely updates, and participate in retrospectives.

Key Components

- **JIRA Board & Dashboard Setup**
 - Define clear board swimlanes and statuses.
 - Configure dashboards for **throughput, cycle time, and delivery tracking**.
- **Metrics & Reporting**
 - Focus on measurable KPIs such as **Lead Time, Cycle Time, and Throughput** instead of sprint points.
 - Dashboards to provide ongoing visibility to **leadership and management**.
- **Refinement & Story Pointing Sessions**
 - Conduct **regular refinement sessions** to assign story points and validate priorities.
 - These sessions will:
 - Assign story points.
 - Clarify blockers and dependencies.
 - Establish delivery targets and expectations.
 - Include Brenda when needed for **timeline alignment and delivery push**.
 - **Brenda** will join selected refinement sessions to emphasize priorities, clarify blockers, and ensure timely delivery from offshore teams.
- **Backlog Definition** – Establish clear criteria for how stories enter the workflow and when they're ready for execution.
- **Offshore Coordination**
 - Offshore teams **will not conduct daily stand-ups** but must:
 - Provide asynchronous updates via JIRA.
 - Attend scheduled refinement/review calls for alignment.
 - Commit to delivery timelines defined during refinement sessions.
 - Brenda and Swapnil will coordinate to **reinforce timelines and accountability**.
- **Continuous Improvement & Working Agreement**
 - A **team working agreement** will be drafted to clarify expectations, ownership, and process flow.
 - Retrospectives and lessons learned will feed into ongoing improvements.
 - Refinement cadence will be reviewed periodically based on team bandwidth and offshore coordination needs.

Offshore Coordination & Delivery Focus

- Offshore teams will **not hold daily stand-ups**, but will be expected to:
 - Attend **scheduled refinement and review sessions** to discuss priorities and progress.
 - Update task statuses and blockers in JIRA proactively.
 - Provide brief progress summaries during designated syncs.
- This approach ensures **less meeting fatigue**, more **focused delivery discussions**, and **measurable accountability** through dashboards and cycle metrics.

Next Steps

This page will serve as the **master reference** for all upcoming drafts, templates, and finalized processes under the Kanban improvement initiative. Brenda will begin by adding initial drafts for:

- Brenda to schedule the **working sessions** to define the **working agreement** and refinement cadence.
- Swapnil to provide **technical process overview** and reporting setup for visibility.
- Dhanashree and offshore team to review **proposed board setup** and provide feedback.
- Add subsequent draft pages under this page

Goal:

To establish a **lean, transparent, and results-driven Kanban workflow** that enhances visibility, collaboration, and delivery consistency across onshore and offshore teams.